

AGENDA: WEEK TWO
Revised 4/25
Welcome Back to the 4th Step Workshop

Congratulations! Good job for making the decision to take on your own life!

1. Please join us in the Serenity Prayer

2. Introductions all around

3. Housekeeping Items...

- If the door is closed before 7 pm, we are doing some prep work
- Please silence your cell phone
- Different 12 step groups are represented here tonight, so please be considerate
- Speak loudly and clearly so all can hear what you have to share
- Raise your hand if you can't hear others or the Facilitators
- Circulate attendance sheet (for our use)
- We pass the basket to help cover cost for workshop space rental, materials, etc
- Suggested donation is \$20 for entire workshop (only if able)
- Bathrooms are down the hall all the way on your right

4. Discussion Topics

- **How did your week go?**
- **Did you have trouble coming up with resentments?**
- **Did you have more or less than you thought you would have?**
- **What were some of the feelings that surfaced?**
- **Did anyone find it helpful to use sponsors and facilitators?**
- **Did anyone have trouble finishing the assignment? Emphasize catching up**
- **Did anyone see that it was what they did in column 2, NOT who did it in column 1 that caused the resentment? READ TWICE**

5. A reading from the Big Book (Page 65, paragraph 1 through top of page 66)

"On our grudge list, we set opposite each name, our injuries. Was it our self-esteem, our security, our ambitions, our personal or sex relations, which had been interfered with? We went back through our lives. Nothing counted but thoroughness and honesty. When we were finished, we considered it carefully. The first thing apparent was that this world and its people were often quite wrong. To conclude that others were wrong was as far as most of us ever got. The usual outcome was that people continued to wrong us and we stayed sore. Sometimes it was remorse and then we were sore at ourselves. But the more we fought and tried to have our own way, the worse matters got. As in war, the victor only seemed to win. Our moments of triumph were short-lived."

6. Introduction to Column 3

Read from **Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions**.

“Creation gave us instincts for a purpose. Without them we wouldn’t be complete human beings. If men and women didn’t exert themselves to be secure in their persons, make no effort to harvest food or construct shelter, there would be no survival. If they didn’t reproduce, the earth wouldn’t be populated. If there were no social instinct, if men cared nothing for the society of one another, there would be no society. So their desire for the sex relation, for material and emotional security, and for companionship are perfectly necessary and right, and surely God-given.

Yet these instincts, so necessary for our existence, often far exceed their proper functions. Powerfully, blindly, many times subtly, they drive us, dominate us, and insist upon ruling our lives. Our desires for sex, for material and emotional security, and for an important place in society often tyrannize us. When thus out of joint, man’s natural desires cause him great trouble, practically all the trouble there is. No human being, however good, is exempt from these troubles. Nearly every serious emotional problem can be seen as a case of misdirected instinct. When that happens, our great natural assets, the instincts, have turned into physical and mental liabilities”. (Step 4, page 42)

Column 1 is Who Harmed Us

Column 2 is What They Did

Column 3 is How We Were Affected

7. Which parts of Self were affected? Column 3

- Pull out The Glossary & talk about importance of using our definitions, not theirs
- Read definition for Social Instinct, then Self Esteem.
- Work the column top to bottom
- Call on Facilitators to continue reading glossary definitions
- Repeat with all columns in column 3, top to bottom

8. Re-emphasize doing **one column at a time** (cover other columns to right with The Glossary)

9. Take Questions

10. Assignments

- **Column 3 of Resentments Sheet**
- **Use Glossary**
- **Call your sponsor**
- **Use the phone list and call/text Facilitators**
- **“Please join us in the Serenity Prayer”**